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Adyen

Team Lead, Learning & Development

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Dear Adyen team,

At Windesheim, I built what Adyen describes as its L&D North Star: a learning environment where business problems drive the design, not the other way around. The Spark! Living Lab is not a curriculum. It is a living system: researchers bring problems, students build solutions, and the learning happens in the work. It has been running for five years and I am not involved in its day-to-day anymore. That is what good L&D infrastructure looks like.

The proof of method: in 2021, I merged eight separate university courses into one sprint-based program in under two months. Faculty with conflicting priorities, separate student cohorts, and no shared budget. I designed the integration using SafeScrum, ran daily standups to align eight course leads, and rebuilt the assessment model around shared sprint outputs. All eight courses delivered on time. Two have since referenced the model in their own redesigns.

Adyen's L&D Core team sits at the intersection of strategy and delivery: define a North Star, then build the ecosystem that makes it real. I have done this three times from zero: Spark! Living Lab (2020, still running), the Value Chain Hackers AI compliance lab (cross-European, active), and the AI research sandbox at Windesheim (self-funded, deployed on my own infrastructure). The pattern is the same: set the learning architecture, bring in the right people, design for outcomes not attendance.

The Amsterdam commute from Baarn is 40 minutes. I have done it regularly before and it works.

Kind regards,

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